April 11, 2025

Ms. Danica Irvine
Alternate Designated Agency Ethics Official
Office of the General Counsel
Department of Defense
Washington, DC 20310

Dear Ms. Irvine:

The purpose of this letter is to describe the steps that I will take to avoid any actual or apparent conflict of interest in the event that I am confirmed for the position of Assistant Secretary of Defense for Special Operations/Low Intensity Conflict, Department of Defense. It is my responsibility to understand and comply with commitments outlined in this agreement.

SECTION 1 – GENERAL COMMITMENTS

As required by the criminal conflicts of interest law at 18 U.S.C. § 208(a), I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter in which I know that I have a financial interest directly and predictably affected by the matter, or in which I know that a person whose interests are imputed to me has a financial interest directly and predictably affected by the particular matter, unless I first obtain a written waiver, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(1), or qualify for a regulatory exemption, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(2). I understand that the interests of the following persons are imputed to me:

- Any spouse or minor child of mine;
- Any general partner of a partnership in which I am a limited or general partner;
- Any organization in which I serve as an officer, director, trustee, general partner, or employee, even if uncompensated; and
- Any person or organization with which I am negotiating or have an arrangement concerning prospective employment.

In the event that an actual or potential conflict of interest arises during my appointment, I will consult with an agency ethics official and take the measures necessary to resolve the conflict, such as recusal from the particular matter or divestiture of an asset.

If I have a managed account or otherwise use the services of an investment professional during my appointment, I will ensure that the account manager or investment professional obtains my prior approval on a case-by-case basis for the purchase of any assets other than cash, cash equivalents, investment funds that qualify for the regulatory exemption for diversified mutual funds and unit investment trusts at 5 C.F.R. § 2640.201(a), obligations of the United States, or municipal bonds.

I will receive a live ethics briefing from a member of the ethics office after my confirmation but not later than 7 days after my appointment pursuant to the ethics program regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2638.305. Within 90 days of my confirmation, I will submit my

Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance which documents my compliance with this ethics agreement.

I will not modify this ethics agreement without your approval and the approval of the U.S. Office of Government Ethics (OGE) pursuant to the ethics agreement requirements contained in the financial disclosure regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2634.803(a)(4).

SECTION 2 – STANDARD METAL, INC.

Upon confirmation, I will resign from my position with Standard Metal, Inc. I will continue to have a financial interest in this entity, but I will not provide services material to the production of income. Instead, I will receive only passive investment income from it. I will retain use of a Standard Metal company truck after my resignation. I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter that to my knowledge has a direct and predictable effect on the financial interests of Standard Metal, unless I first obtain a written waiver, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(1).

SECTION 3 – BLOOMING, INC.

Upon confirmation, I will resign from my position with Blooming, Inc. Pursuant to an agreement reached with the owners of Blooming, Inc., the corporation will pay me a severance payment totaling $140,000. Until I have received these payments, I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter that to my knowledge has a direct and predictable effect on the ability or willingness of Blooming, Inc. to make these payments to me, unless I first obtain a written waiver, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(1). Pursuant to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, for a period of one year after my resignation or until I receive my last payment, whichever is later, I also will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which I know Blooming, Inc. is a party or represents a party, unless I am first authorized to participate, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).

SECTION 4 – PROVOCO

I was the sole proprietor of my consulting firm, which did business as Provoco, Inc. My consulting firm has ceased engaging in any business, including the representation of clients and no longer exists as a business entity. Pursuant to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which I know a former client of mine is a party or represents a party for a period of one year after I last provided service to that client, unless I am first authorized to participate, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).

SECTION 5 – SPOUSE EMPLOYMENT

My spouse serves as a consultant to Classical Conversations, Inc., for which my spouse receives consulting fees. Pursuant to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, for as long as my spouse continues to consult for Classical Conversations, Inc., I will not participate

personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which I know Classical Conversations, Inc. is a party or represents a party, unless I am first authorized to participate, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).

SECTION 6 - OTHER COMMITMENTS

In addition to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, I understand that as an employee of the Department of Defense I will be required to comply with Section 1117 of the National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2022. Therefore, for a period of two years after my resignation from any organization, including a trade organization, for which I served as an employee, officer, director, trustee, or general partner, I will not knowingly participate personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which that organization is a party or represents a party to the matter, unless I am authorized to participate, pursuant to Section 1117(b).

SECTION 7 – PUBLIC POSTING

I have been advised that this ethics agreement and the Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance will be posted publicly, consistent with the public information law at 5 U.S.C. § 552, on the website of the U.S. Office of Government Ethics with ethics agreements of other presidential nominees who file public financial disclosure reports.

Sincerely,

Michael James Jensen

Michael J. Jensen